

Project Context — Live Streaming Social App

Yeh document ek naye chat mein context dene ke liye hai. Ismein ab tak ke saare decisions, numbers aur constraints hain.

0. Kaun hai, kya ban raha hai

Founder: Full-stack developer — React Native + Expo, backend design, cloud hosting, infrastructure ka experience. India (Delhi) mein based. Abhi solo kaam kar raha hai, ek partner hai, team baad mein expand hogi.

Product: Live streaming + voice/video party room social app — Bigo Live / Poppo Live / Vone jaisa model. India-first, virtual gifting economy ke saath.

Business model: Users real paise se coins kharidte hain → hosts ko gift bhejte hain → hosts points kamate hain → INR withdraw karte hain. Platform beech ka spread rakhta hai.

1. Positioning — abhi tak decide nahi hua

Teen options discuss hue:

1. Regional-first (Bhojpuri / Marathi / Bengali / Tamil creator community)
2. Interest-vertical (music, gaming co-watch, language exchange)
3. **Audio-first + ek regional language** ← recommended

Audio-first ka case: RTC cost 4-5x kam, moderation risk kam, women hosts ke liye safer perception (supply side ka biggest differentiator).

STATUS: OPEN — partner ke saath decide karna hai.

2. HARD RULES — inko kabhi mat todna

Legal red lines

1. **Koi paid chance-based game nahi.** Golden Flower, Fun Island, lucky boxes, mystery gifts — kuch nahi. India ka Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act 2025 (Rules 1 May 2026 se force mein) sabhi online money games ko ban karta hai, aur skill vs chance ka distinction khatam kar chuka hai. Yeh existential risk hai.
2. **Agency kabhi host ka paisa hold nahi karegi.** Platform har host ko directly pay karta hai. Agency ko commission alag se milta hai. Agar paisa agency ke through jaaye toh woh RBI Payment Aggregator banti hai (PSS Act 2007) — ₹15 cr net worth + escrow requirement, jo koi agency meet nahi kar sakti.
3. **Reseller pehle pay karega, tab coins milenge.** Credit par kabhi nahi. Pehle pay = distributor (legal). Baad mein pay = payment intermediary (illegal).

4. **"Salary" word kabhi use nahi.** Hosts ke liye "earnings" ya "payout". Mandated hours, penalties, forced exclusivity — sab employment classification risk hain (PF, ESI, gratuity).
5. **18+ only.** Payout se pehle PAN + face match mandatory. Minor host = existential risk.
6. **Grievance Officer** India-resident, contact publicly published — IT Rules 2021 mandatory.

Store fee reality

- Google Play India ka alternative billing sirf **4% reduction** deta hai — bekaar hai
- Google ne **anti-steering worldwide hata di hai** — web shop in-app promote kar sakte ho, par in-app link click ke 24 ghante ke andar hui purchase par **20% fee** lagti hai
- Isliye web recharge portal **app se independently discoverable** hona chahiye (SEO, WhatsApp, reseller channels), app se driven nahi

3. Roles

In-app

Role	Kaam	Kamai
Viewer	Dekhata, chat, gift bhejta	— (kharch karta hai)
Host	Live aata hai, content banata hai	Gift value ka 60%, points mein
Talent agency	Hosts recruit + train + retain	Host earnings par 5-20% commission
Sub-agent	Agency ke under, apne hosts laata hai	Agency uska share deti hai
Coin reseller	Bulk coins kharid ke users ko bechta hai	~12% resale margin

Do alag "agency" — confuse mat karna:

- Talent agency = supply side, hosts, commission kamati hai, points wallet
- Coin reseller = demand side, coins kharidta hai apne paise se, resale margin, coins wallet

Viewer states: Guest → Registered → Paying → VIP tier → Whale **Host states:** Applicant → Verified → Solo/Agency host → Signed host · (Suspended/Banned) **Room-level roles:** Room admin · Seat guest · Top gifter (host deta hai, us room tak scoped)

Internal (admin RBAC)

Super admin · Ops manager · Content moderator · T&S lead · Finance operator · Finance approver · Risk analyst · Support agent · Agency manager · Growth · Data analyst · Engineer · Grievance Officer · Auditor

Maker-checker mandatory: finance operator aur approver alag log.

DB design rules

1. `users.role` column mat banao — `role_assignments` table with `scope_type` + `scope_id`
 2. Revoke = `revoked_at` set karo, delete kabhi nahi
 3. `host_agency_links` apni table, `effective_from` / `effective_to` ke saath. Commission gift ke timestamp par calculate ho, current link par nahi
 4. Permissions role se decoupled, config mein — hardcoded nahi
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4. Economy — saare numbers

Base rates

Coin rate	65 coins = ₹1
Gift split (paid coins)	Host ko 60%, points mein
Gift split (bonus coins)	Host ko 20%
Point rate	130 points = ₹1
Effective payout (gifting)	~30%
Blended payout target	22-25%

Two-dial mechanic: Dial 1 = gift split % (public marketing number). Dial 2 = point-to-rupee rate (wallet mein chhupa). Dono milke 60% advertise hota hai par 30% actual payout banta hai.

Coin packs

Pack	Price	Total coins	Effective rate
Starter (lifetime once)	₹19	4,300	226/₹
Small	₹99	6,750	68/₹
Popular	₹299	21,800	73/₹
Value	₹999	78,000	78/₹
Big	₹2,999	249,500	83/₹
Whale	₹9,999	877,500	88/₹

Totals jaan-boojh ke awkward — gift prices se exact match na ho, balance hamesha kuch bacha rahe.

Gift catalog — 24 gifts, 5 tiers

Tier	Range	Examples	Effect
1 Impulse	₹0.15 – 4.60	Heart, Rose, Chai, Laddu, Clap	Basic
2 Regular	₹8 – 40	Perfume, Teddy, Guitar, Cake, Bouquet	Basic
3 Statement	₹75 – 300	Fireworks, Motorbike, Diamond ring, Yacht	Full-screen animation
4 Flex	₹750 – 3,000	Sports car, Private jet, Castle	Room banner + host notification
5 Global	₹7,500 – 15,000	Rocket, Galaxy	Saare rooms mein announcement

Combo multipliers: x1 → x10 → x99 → x520 → x999 (520 = "I love you", 999 = forever)

Cosmetics — ZERO payout, poora margin

Target: coin spend ka 20-25% yahan jaana chahiye. Yeh sabse sasta margin lever hai.

VIP monthly: Silver ₹100 · Gold ₹500 · Platinum ₹2,000 · Diamond ₹10,000 One-time (30 din): Profile frame ₹50 · Chat bubble ₹30 · Entry effect basic ₹100 / premium ₹400 · Nickname color ₹20 · Super message ₹80

Sab expiring — permanent one-time revenue hai, monthly recurring.

Levels

User level: lifetime **paid** coin spend par (bonus count nahi). L1-70. **Kabhi neeche nahi girta.** **Host level:** cumulative points. Fan club L26 par unlock (grind ka reason).

Agency commission tiers

Pichle 30 din ki total host earnings par:

Monthly host earnings	Commission
₹0 - 50,000	5%
₹50K - 2L	8%
₹2L - 5L	12%
₹5L - 15L	16%
₹15L+	20%

Daily/task/bonus-coin earnings par commission **nahi** (reward farming rokne ke liye).
Commission host ki earning se nahi katta — platform apni taraf se deta hai.

Free coin economy

Budget: paid coin revenue ka **max 8%**. Signup 500 · Daily check-in 20→150 streak · Watch 5min 30 (10x/day) · Follow 20 (5x/day) · Share 50 (3x/day) · Referral 2,000

Bonus coin rules: 30 din expiry · gift par host ko sirf 20% · cosmetics par poora chalega · ledger mein `COIN_BONUS` vs `COIN_PAID` alag accounts · spend order: pehle bonus, phir paid

5. Revenue math

₹1,000 recharge, poorra gifting mein

	Play Store	Web	Reseller
Company ko mila	₹1,000	₹1,000	₹880
GST (18% incl)	-₹152	-₹152	-₹134
Store / gateway	-₹150	-₹20	—
Host	-₹300	-₹300	-₹300
Agency	-₹36	-₹36	-₹36
Server + RTC	-₹35	-₹35	-₹35
Payout charges	-₹8	-₹8	-₹8
Bacha	₹319	₹449	₹367

Wahi ₹1,000 with 20,000 coins on cosmetics (web)

Host -₹208, Agency -₹25 → **₹554 bacha**. Same user, same paisa, **₹105 zyada**.

Health targets

Metric	Target
Coin spend — gifts	75-80%
Coin spend — cosmetics	20-25%
Effective payout ratio	22-25%
Bonus coin cost	≤8% of paid revenue
Blended gross margin	44-48%

Scale reference (10,000 DAU)

MAU ~40,000 · Payers 4% of MAU = 1,600 · Gross ~₹13.76L/month Whale concentration:
2% of payers (32 log) = 35% of revenue Fixed cost at that stage ~₹11L/month → **break-even**
~₹28.6L monthly revenue

Teen dials

1. **Channel mix** — target 70% off-store in 12 months
 2. **Cosmetics share** — target 20-25% (sabse sasta lever)
 3. **Point-to-rupee rate** — aakhri dial, pehla nahi (hosts turant notice karte hain)
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6. Features by phase

Phase 0 (MVP, 4-5 months, ~25 features)

Discovery: live feed, category tabs, following, search Rooms: solo live, party room 4/6/9 seat
Interaction: text chat, mic queue, emoji, beauty filters Gifting: catalog (15-20), room
leaderboard Status: user level Relationship: follow + live notification Daily hooks: check-in,
watch reward, push Host tools: go-live, earnings dashboard, withdrawal, room admin,
mute/kick Wallet: coin packs (IAP + web), paid vs bonus separate Safety: 18+ gate, report,
block, NSFW detection, moderator monitor, Grievance Officer contact

Phase 1 (PMF, 3-4 months)

Trending/nearby/auto-preview · video party room · **private 1-on-1 call** · multi-guest · **PK battle** · live quiz · karaoke · polls · combo gifts · full-screen gifts · global broadcast gift · **VIP tiers + entry effects + frames** · fan club (paid) · fan levels · DM · daily tasks · lucky wheel · events · agency dashboard · reseller wallet · spend limits

Phase 2

Recommendation feed · short video (V-Shorts) · paid-entry rooms · team PK · screen share · guardian slots · CP pairing · family/guild · nickname protection · stealth mode

NEVER (ya legal opinion ke baad only)

Lucky gifts / mystery boxes · koi bhi paid chance-based game

7. Tech architecture

```
Mobile (React Native + Expo)
  └─ RTC media layer (Agora / ZEGO / LiveKit) – media backend se nahi
    guzarta
  └─ REST gateway (auth, wallet, profile)
    └─ WebSocket gateway (chat, gifts, presence)
      └─ Core services: Identity · Room · Wallet ledger · Moderation
        └─ Postgres (ledger, users) · Redis (presence, ranks) · Kafka +
          ClickHouse (events)
```

Day-1 non-negotiables

1. **Double-entry ledger.** (`ledger_accounts`) / (`ledger_txns`) (idempotency_key UNIQUE) / (`ledger_entries`) (signed amounts, sum = 0). Balance kabhi mutable column nahi. Nightly verification job with pager alert.
2. **Idempotency-Key header** har money endpoint par
3. **Coin float = liability, revenue nahi.** Revenue tab recognize hoti hai jab coin kharch ho. CA ko day 1 se batao
4. **API versioning** (`/v1/`) — purane app versions hamesha zinda rehte hain
5. **Force-update + remote kill switch** har major feature ke liye
6. **Server-driven config** — gift catalog, coin packs, levels, room types. Naya gift add karne ke liye app release nahi
7. **EAS Update (OTA)** for JS-level fixes
8. **Structured logging + trace_id** client se DB tak
9. **Terraform IaC**, teen environments (dev/staging/prod)
10. **Admin panel MVP ka hissa hai**, "baad mein" nahi
11. **Kafka event stream day 1 se**, chahe consumer ek ho
12. (`payout_rate`) per-gift field, global constant nahi

8. Growth plan

Sequence: Hosts kharido → rooms bharo → users free channels se → retention fix → agencies se scale → tab ads.

Phase	Kya
1 (M1-2)	50 hosts. Competitor poaching sabse fast. ₹15,000/month guaranteed × 3 months = ₹22.5L. Tapering M4-6, actual-only M7+
2 (M2-3)	1,000 users. Koi paid ads nahi. Host referral links (+10% points 3 months), WhatsApp groups, shareable web preview link, reseller network
3 (M4-8)	Agency network. Existing agencies from Bigo/Poppo poach karo. Launch incentives. Agency dependency 60% se upar mat jaane do
4 (M6+)	Paid ads — tabhi jab D7 > 15%, paying conversion > 2%. Ad creative mein real room screen recordings

Cold start — product se solve

Rooms consolidate (10 ke bajaye 4 dikhao) · peak hours enforce (8-11 PM) · viewer count absolute mat dikhao · naye user ko sabse bhare room mein daalo

Retention targets

Metric	M3	M6	M12
D1	25%	32%	38%
D7	10%	15%	20%
D30	4%	7%	10%
Paying conversion	1.5%	2.5%	4%

Host-side: D7 > 40% · D30 > 25% · 60+ live hours/month

D1 ka killer moment: host naye user ka naam bole ("Welcome Rahul!") — yeh D1 retention 2x karta hai.

Growth budget (12 months)

Host seeding ₹35-45L · Agency incentives ₹8-12L · Paid ads ₹15-25L · Referrals ₹5-8L = **₹63-90L**, product build cost ke upar.

9. Trust & Safety

Phase 0 hai, Phase 1 nahi. Chamet ke 26M Indian downloads the, phir bhi Google ne UGC policy violation par hata diya.

Policy levels

Level	Kya	Action
L1	CSAM, minors, real violence, terrorism	Instant permanent ban + law enforcement + 90-day evidence preserve
L2	Nudity, sexual acts, drugs, self-harm	Stream kill, 7-30 day suspend
L3	Suggestive, abuse, harassment, spam	Warning → mute → 24hr suspend
L4	Off-topic, quality	Warning, room admin handle kare

Detection

Video frame sampling (~2 sec) · audio transcription (~10 sec) · text filter (instant, **Hindi/Hinglish transliteration zaroori**) · behavioural signals Trust-based sampling: naye

hosts 1 sec, trusted 10 sec (~60% cost saving) Confidence routing: >0.9 auto-kill · 0.6-0.9 human queue · <0.6 log Vendor: **Hive** (live streaming par trained)

SLA

L1 < 30 sec · L2 < 2 min · L3 < 15 min · L4 < 4 hrs

Staffing

1 moderator = 10-12 concurrent streams. 100 concurrent = 9/shift = **30+ for 24×7**. Launch: 16-18 hr coverage (10 AM – 4 AM), peak 8 PM – 2 AM. Cost: launch ₹2.4-3.1L/month · scale (100K DAU) ₹13-15L/month

Appeals

App Store review ke liye zaroori. 48hr response, **alag banda** review kare. Target overturn rate 10-20%.

10. Payout operations

Verification (sab mandatory)

PAN (number + name match) · Bank penny drop · Face match vs PAN photo · Age from PAN DOB **Ek PAN = ek host account**. Bank change par **14 din cooling period** (account takeover ka #1 attack vector).

Flow

Points → hold period (7 din standard, 14 naye host) → withdrawable → request → risk check → maker-checker approval → weekly batch → bank

Min ₹1,000 · Max ₹2L per request · Weekly frequency · 2-3 working days

TDS — OPEN DECISION

	194J	194-O
Rate	10%	1%
Threshold	₹50,000/yr	₹5L (individual/HUF)

Zyada tar creator platforms 194-O ki taraf jaate hain. **CA se likhit decision lo aur file mein rakho**. No PAN → 20%.

GST branching

GST-registered host (turnover > ₹20L) → woh invoice deta hai, aap +18% pay karte ho, input credit milta hai Non-registered (~99%) → seedha payment

Payment rails

UPI (₹0-2, ₹1L tak, default) · IMPS (₹5-10, ₹5L tak) · NEFT (bulk) · RTGS (₹2L+) Provider: RazorpayX / Cashfree Payouts / Decentro

Daily reconciliation (automated, mismatch = pager alert)

Ledger balance · txn sum = 0 · coin float · payout vs bank · recharge vs gateway · points issued vs gifts

Edge case policies (ToS mein pehle se likho)

Ban ke baad balance: L1 = forfeit, L2-L3 = payout allowed · Abandoned account: 12 mo notify, 24 mo forfeit · Chargeback after withdraw: **platform bears loss, host se clawback nahi**

11. Data & launch

Event taxonomy

`object_action` naming, past tense. Categories: Session · Auth · Discovery · Room · Engagement · Economy · Host · Safety · Lifecycle Common properties SDK level par auto-attach (user_id, session_id, timestamp, device_id, app_version, platform, country, locale, user_level, is_paying)

Pipeline: App/Server → Kafka → ClickHouse + Postgres + **S3 raw archive** (replay ke liye)
Stack: Kafka + ClickHouse + Metabase (Amplitude/Mixpanel is volume par mehngi)

Daily founder dashboard

DAU · gross recharge · **payout ratio** · channel mix · cosmetics share · active hosts + live hours · concurrent peak · moderation actions

Launch phases

Phase	Duration	Scope
A Closed beta	4 weeks	30-50 hosts, ~500 users. Exit: crash-free >99%, ledger zero mismatch 7 days, payout batch reconciled, L1 <30 sec
B Soft launch	6 weeks	Play Store, ek region. Android pehle (India ka market Android hai, Apple review stricter). Week 1-2 organic only
C Public	—	Gates cross hone par. Phir iOS, phir ads

Store submission

Google: honest content rating, data safety form, 18+, live privacy policy URL, UGC moderation description ready **Apple:** Guideline 1.2 ke liye demonstrate karo — filtering,

reporting, blocking, published contact. **Demo account with content** do (khaali app reject hota hai)

First 30 days war room

Daily standup ke 3 sawaal: **Kya toota? Kya paisa leak hua? Kya safety incident hua?**

12. Team plan

Stage	Hires
Now → MVP	Senior backend engineer pehle (RN aap khud kar lo). UI/UX contract. CA + CS retainer (₹15-25K/mo). Tech lawyer (₹1.5-3L one-time)
Launch → 10K DAU	+1 backend, +1 mobile, DevOps (PT), community/host manager 1-2, 4 moderators , support 1-2, growth contract
10K → 100K DAU	Eng ~10, T&S lead + 15-25 moderators , finance 1-2, risk analyst, agency managers 2-3, support 5-8, data analyst

Structural fact: scale par non-engineering headcount total ka **60-70%** hota hai (moderation + support + payout ops). Financial model mein isko engineering se zyada weight do.

Legal: full-time lawyer Series A tak nahi. CA + CS day 0, tech lawyer month 2-3, **gaming law written opinion** product spec freeze par (₹1-2L) — yeh document Play Store appeals aur investor diligence dono mein kaam aayega.

13. OPEN DECISIONS

#	Decision	Owner
1	Niche/positioning (audio-first + regional recommended)	Founders
2	Equity split + vesting (4yr, 1yr cliff)	Founders
3	App name	Founders
4	TDS section — 194J vs 194-O	CA
5	RTC vendor — Agora vs ZEGO vs LiveKit, actual pricing par	Founder
6	Bootstrap runway vs funding timing	Founders
7	Founder role split (product+tech vs ops+growth+agency)	Founders

14. Cost summary

Item	Amount
MVP build (4-6 months, SDK-assembled)	₹40-80L
Growth spend (12 months)	₹63-90L
Monthly fixed at 10K DAU	~₹11L
Break-even revenue	~₹28.6L/month
Monthly T&S (launch)	₹2.4-3.1L

15. Documents already created

1. `live-app-founding-plan.md` — tech foundation, team, compliance, 90-day plan
2. `app-blueprint-v1.md` — roles, features, revenue model
3. `economy-design-v1.md` — coin packs, gifts, cosmetics, levels, commission
4. `growth-plan-v1.md` — host seeding, acquisition, agencies, retention
5. `trust-and-safety-v1.md` — policy, detection, moderation, appeals
6. `payout-operations-v1.md` — verification, TDS, GST, approvals, reconciliation
7. `data-and-launch-plan-v1.md` — event taxonomy, dashboards, launch phases

Sab numbers starting points hain, final nahi. Launch ke 3 mahine baad data dekh ke tune karna hoga. Legal/tax items par lawyer aur CA se confirm karna zaroori hai.